

Dominic & Partners

Partner for a better tomorrow.
Audit | Tax | Advisory

Branches: Dubai, Abu Dhabi, Sharjah, RAK and Riyadh, Saudi Arabia
Suite B 3001, Latifa tower, Sheikh Zayed Road, Dubai
info@domuae.com | www.domuae.com | Dubai +971 56 6040 648 | +971 50 9801 263

354578 11



Dubai Media Office

■ His Highness Sheikh Mohammed Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Vice-President and Prime Minister of the UAE and Ruler of Dubai, honours Abdoullie Jobe, Gambia's Minister of Tourism and Culture, with the World's Best Minister award as part of the 2026 World Governments Summit, in recognition of his exceptional achievements and their significant positive impact on the tourism and culture sectors in his country.

‘Not another war’: UAE seeks US–Iran dialogue

GARGASH SAYS SUSTAINED DIPLOMACY ONLY WAY AHEAD

DUBAI
BY DHANUSHA GOKULAN
Chief Reporter

The UAE has urged the United States and Iran to enter direct negotiations to avoid another destabilising conflict in the Middle East, warning that the region has already paid a heavy price for repeated confrontations.

Speaking at the World Governments Summit in Dubai, Dr Anwar Gargash, Diplomatic Advisor to the UAE President, said fatigue with conflict is growing and that unresolved tensions with Iran continue to fuel uncertainty. “I think that the region has gone through various calamitous confrontations,” Gargash said. “I don’t think we need another one.”

Dr Gargash said sustained diplomacy — particularly direct American-Iranian negotiations — was the only way to address long-standing disputes that continue to resurface.

Direct negotiations

“I would like to see direct Iranian American negotiations leading to understandings that we don’t have these issues every other day,” he said, pointing to Iran’s nuclear programme as a core source of instability.

He argued that Iran today faces mounting pressure to strike a deal, both economically and geopolitically. “I think Iran today needs to reach a deal,” Dr Gargash said, adding that the country’s economy needs rebuilding and that this would require repairing relations with

‘ANTI-UAE CAMPAIGNS BOT-DRIVEN NOISE’

Senior Emirati diplomat Dr Anwar Gargash dismissed online criticism of the UAE during a session at the World Governments Summit in Dubai this week, dismissing much of it as artificial and inauthentic noise. Dr Gargash, the Diplomatic Advisor to the UAE President, told audiences that the recent surge of “anti-UAE rhetoric” across digital platforms is not representative of real views but appears to be driven largely by automated accounts and coordinated online campaigns.

“It’s important to separate the noise from reality,” Gargash said, adding, “When you look beyond the flashpoint social media feeds, traditional conversations and diplomatic engagements tell a very different story about how the UAE is perceived.” He cited an example of how activity around one issue — Sudan — fluctuated suddenly and dramatically, implying the shifts did not reflect genuine shifts in public opinion, but rather algorithm-driven campaigns moving from topic to topic.

“We were seeing around 45,000 hostile tweets a day on Sudan, and then suddenly Yemen became the issue and that number dropped to about 3,000. The same group simply moved on to another file,” said Dr Gargash.

Speaking at the summit, Dr Gargash stressed that dismissing every criticism outright would be unwise, but that policymakers must be savvy about what’s real — and what’s noise. — D.G.



Virendra Saklani/Gulf News

■ Dr Anwar Gargash speaks during a session on the opening day of the World Governments Summit in Dubai yesterday.

Washington. He said a broader political and geostrategic agreement could be “beneficial to the area” while also helping Iran meet its own long-term needs.

Former US Secretary of State Mike Pompeo, who served during Donald Trump’s first administration, said he found it hard to believe that any deal could deliver lasting peace under Iran’s current leadership.

“To think that there’s a long-term solution that actually provides stability and peace to this region while the Ayatollah is still in power is something I pray for, but find unimaginable,” he said.

Atlantic Council president and CEO Fred Kempe said Iran’s strategic position has weakened sharply, creating what he described as a pivotal moment.

SEE ALSO P8-9

Dubai unveils Glydways autonomous vehicles

First rollout to take place later this year, trial in next 4 months

DUBAI
BY ZAINAB HUSAIN
Features Writer



Dubai’s Roads and Transport Authority (RTA) is preparing to launch a new autonomous automated transit network, Glydways, in a move aimed at easing congestion and improving mobility across key areas of the city.

Speaking to *Gulf News* on the sidelines of the World Governments Summit 2026, Mark Seeger, CEO of Glydways, said operations are expected to begin later this year, with a trial launch of the first phase planned within the next four months. “The RTA has already planned four routes, but within the next four months we’ll be launching the first trial route,” Seeger noted.

Glydways is a San Francisco-based transportation technology company developing an on-demand, autonomous personal rapid transit (PRT) network. The system is designed to provide driverless, point-to-point travel while reducing traffic on busy urban roads. The first rollout is expected to cover four major areas in Dubai, namely:

■ **Bluewaters:** A route is planned from National Paints Metro Station to Bluewaters Island (2.8km) (trial route)

■ **Umm Suqeim:** The service may connect Mall of the Emirates Metro Station with Madinat Jumeirah (1.9km)

■ **Al Quoz:** A corridor is expected to run from OnPassive to Alserkal Avenue and Times Square Centre (2.6km)

■ **Dubai Festival City:** The system will operate within the Dubai Festival City area, with the possibility of a future connection to the Metro Blue Line (7km)

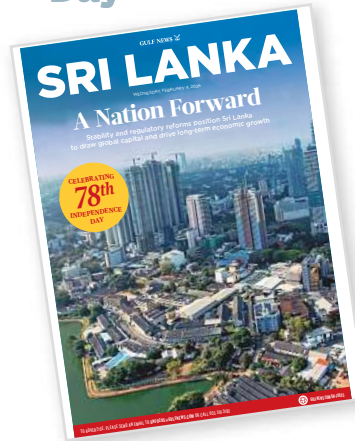
Glydways vehicles are autonomous and electric, travelling at speeds of up to 50km/h. Each vehicle can carry four to six passengers and has a range of up to 250km on a single charge. “You hail this like a taxi and then the fare is pegged to the local transit fare system. So you get your whole vehicle on demand, with no people sharing the vehicle, for the same cost as a bus or a train ticket,” Seeger said.

BUSINESS

Indian expats in UAE welcome easing of gold customs rule in Budget 2026 | P-1

SPECIAL REPORT

Sri Lanka celebrates 78th Independence Day



Subscribe in print and online

www.store.gulfnews.com
www.gulfnews.com/subscriptions
Tel: 600 587 234
E mail: circ@gulfnews.com

PRICE
UAE: Dh 5.00
Bahrain: BD 0.500
Oman: RO 0.500
India: Rs 40.00
S.Arabia: SR 5.00
Pakistan: Rs 100.00



One Key, Many Opportunities.

BARJEEL GEOJIT
INDIA OPPORTUNITIES FUND

Powered by 10 UCITS Funds

NFO End Date: 13th Feb 2026

Fund Features:

SCA Regulated

USD Denominated

Face Value \$10

Minimum Investment \$5,000

Tax Efficient

Trusted Partners

Open to All Nationalities



Scan to Learn More



Disclaimer: Barjeel Geojit Financial Services LLC is licensed by the CMA in the UAE for Investment Fund Management (Category 2) and for Promotion and Introduction (Category 5). Investments in Mutual Funds are subject to market risks. Please read the prospectus carefully before investing.

+971 4 3060900 - DUBAI | +971 2 4125000 - ABU DHABI | +971 6 5932000 - SHARJAH

bgiof@barjeel.ae | f t i n / barjeelgeojit | www.barjeel.ae

354578 21

SPORT

Abu Dhabi can be the starting point for a good season, Bencic says

Defending champion opens her campaign today | P12

